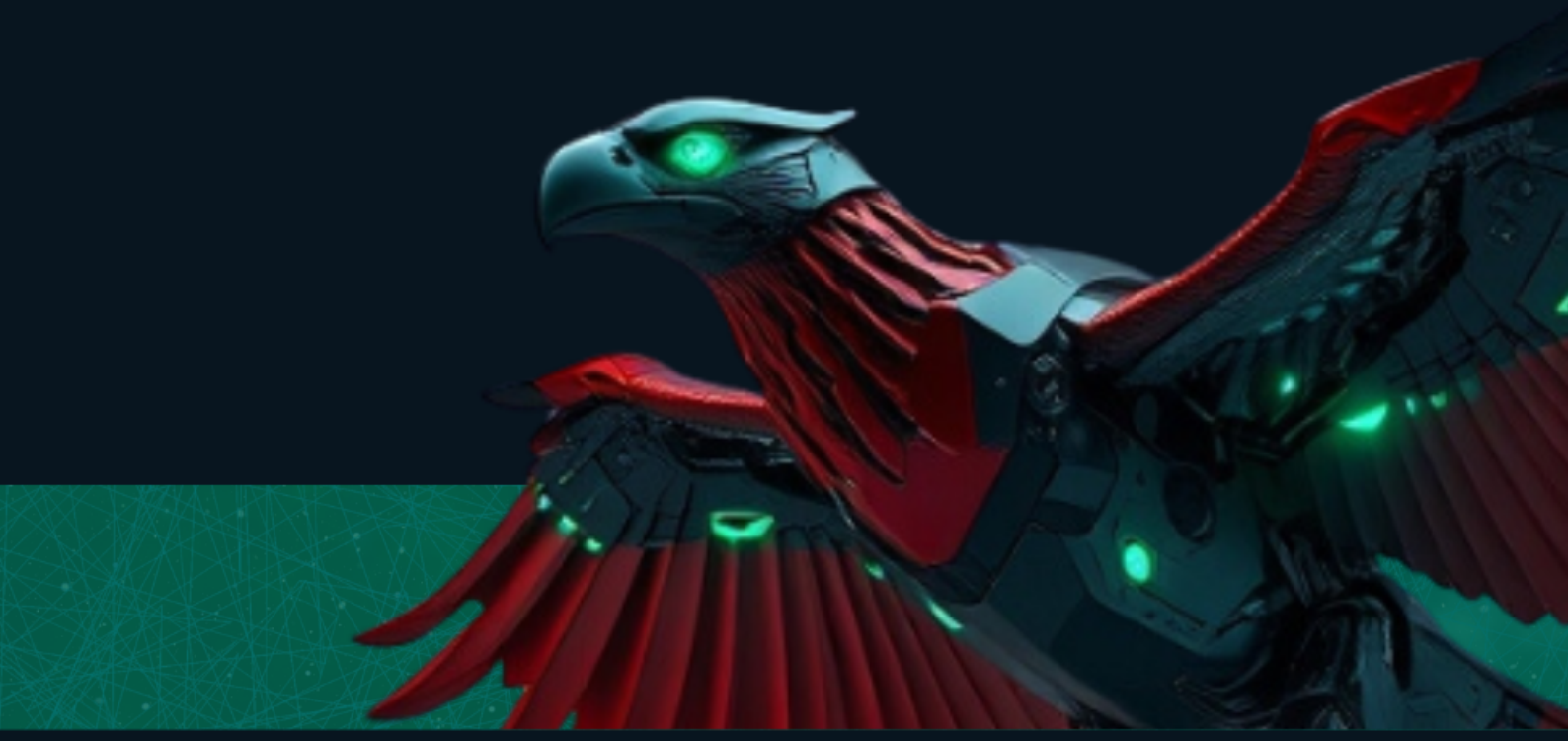
SOCBYTE
ALL BYTES SECURED

CASE REPORT



Case Details

Reference ID	CTHTY-279
Title	Incident Response | TreatAs.sct
Status	Closed
Severity	High
Tactics	Command and Control
Created By	christopher.mirro@thevsoc.com
Created At	Sep 16, 2026, 08:00 PM
Category	Stealth
Sub-Category	Indirect Command Execution
Tenant	Cythority
Age	1 minute
Offense ID	—

Groups & Contributors

Assigned Groups

SOC-Cythority

Contributors

christopher.mirro@thevsoc.com

Analysis Summary

On September 16th at 7:30pm , Cythrority's VSOC investigated a High alert/detection on SentinelOne. Static malware detection for a Windows Script Component (.sct) file named TreatAs.sct on endpoint WIN-2QONSK2IV9E (Windows Server 2022) was discovered. The file hash (7cff5bbf29a20117f20fa39d51426898e81d467ce79beac22e791cf760408d29) matches known malicious payloads associated with Component Object Model (COM) hijacking execution techniques.

The file was dropped and executed via an interactive PowerShell session under the compromised domain administrator account SOCBYTE\Administrator. The adversary attempted to leverage COM Hijacking to establish persistent, elevated code execution. By modifying COM registry configurations (specifically targeting the TreatAs subkey), the attacker can force standard Windows applications to load and execute custom malicious scripts instead of legitimate system binaries whenever the

targeted CLSID is invoked. Because the endpoint policy was configured to Detect mode, SentinelOne logged the event but did not automatically isolate the host or quarantine the script.

This event represents a Confirmed Malicious Threat involving credential compromise and persistence staging. Immediate host containment, credential revocation for SOCBYTE\Administrator, and sweeping for additional lateral movement across the domain are required.

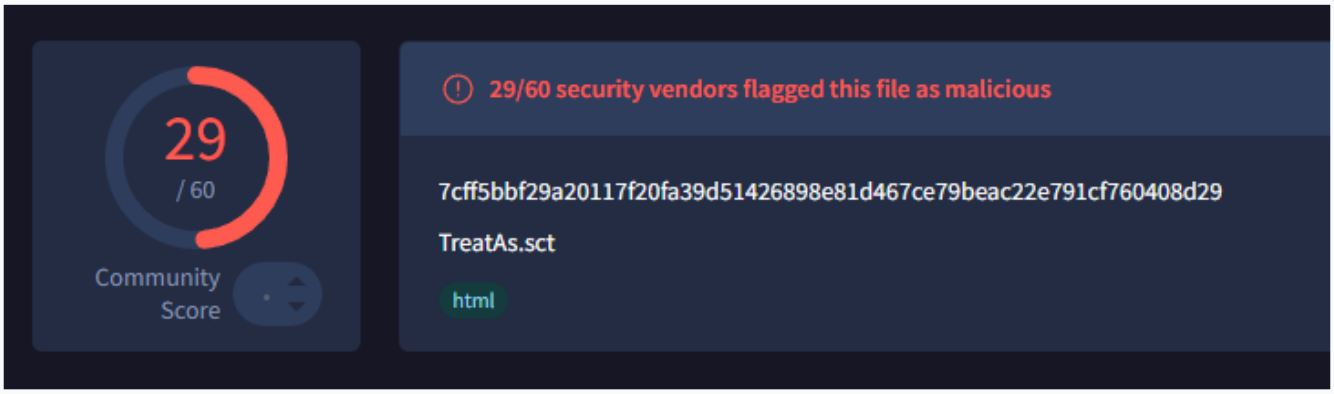
Business & Infrastructure Impact:

- **Privileged Persistence**: Allows the adversary to maintain elevated, stealthy access across system reboots without relying on standard autostart mechanisms (e.g., Run keys or Scheduled Tasks).
- **Lateral Movement & Domain Escalation**: Operating with valid domain administrator rights (SOCBYTE\Administrator) allows the threat actor to pivot laterally, compromise adjacent infrastructure, and access sensitive domain data.
- **Operational Disruption**: Unchecked persistence at the domain level provides a staging ground for credential dumping, enterprise-wide ransomware deployment, or complete infrastructure takeover.

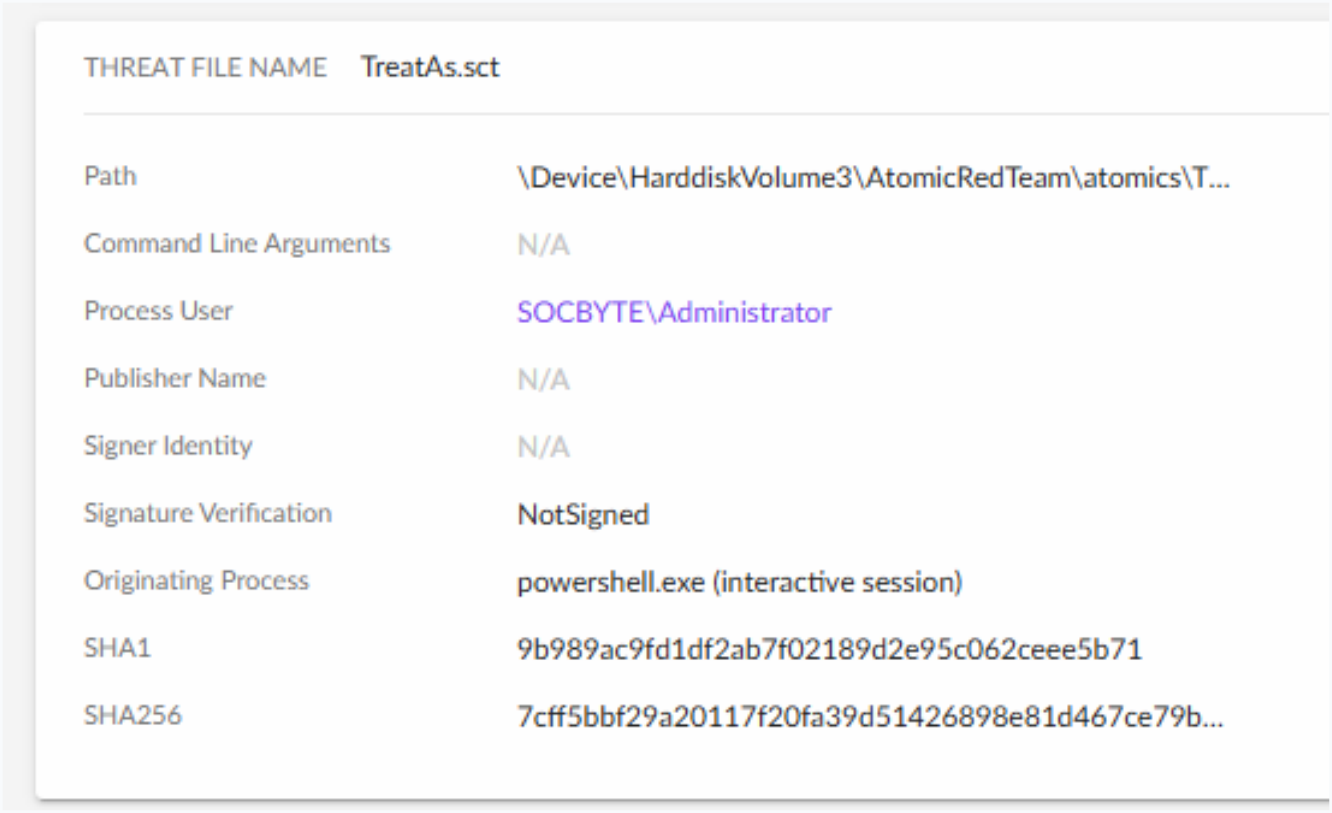
MITRE ATT&CK TTP MAPPING:

- **T1546.015 -** Event Triggered Execution: Component Object Model Hijacking. Detection Mapping: The threat actor created TreatAs.sct to manipulate COM registry structures (TreatAs subkey) and redirect system invocations to malicious code.
- **T1059.001** - Command and Scripting Interpreter: PowerShell. Detection Mapping: Originating execution was captured as an interactive powershell.exe session launching the script payload.
- **T1078.002** - Valid Accounts: Domain Accounts. Detection Mapping: Activity was executed using legitimate, high-privilege domain credentials (SOCBYTE\Administrator).
- **T1547** - Boot or Logon Autostart Execution. Detection Mapping: Exploiting the Windows COM subsystem enables passive autostart execution upon normal system/application operation.

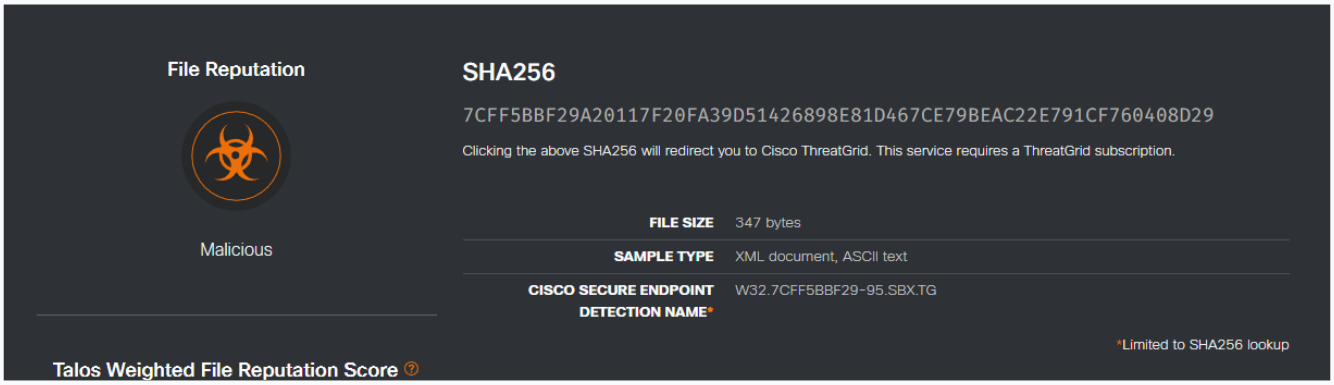
Evidence



Evidence 1



Evidence 2



Evidence 3

Remediation

- **Isolate the Endpoint**: Immediately disconnect WIN-2QONSK2IV9E from the network via SentinelOne console or physically to stop potential C2 communications or lateral movement.
- **Revoke & Reset Credentials**: Force a password reset for SOCBYTE\Administrator and terminate all active, logged-in user sessions tied to this account across the domain.
- **Audit & Revert COM Registry Keys**: Inspect the Windows Registry (specifically HKCU\Software\Classes\CLSID and HKLM\Software\Classes\CLSID) for unauthorized modifications to the TreatAs subkey and restore the affected CLSIDs to their default configuration.
- **Remove Malicious File Payload**: Safely purge TreatAs.sct and any related temporary artifacts staged in the directory path.
- **Inspect Active Execution & Services**: Check active background processes, Scheduled Tasks, and Services to ensure no secondary persistence mechanisms or reverse shells were established under the administrator session.
- **Update Agent Policy**: Switch the SentinelOne agent policy on this endpoint and server group from Detect to Protect/Prevent mode to automatically block and quarantine future malicious drops.
- **Isolate the Host Network Connection**: Use the EDR console (or disconnect physical/virtual network adapters) to initiate host isolation. This immediately blocks all inbound and outbound network traffic while keeping the EDR agent's communication line open for remediation.
- **Terminate Active RDP & Remote Sessions**: Forcefully terminate all active user sessions and open interactive shells on the host (rwinsta for RDP sessions or killing active powershell.exe / cmd.exe processes tied to the incident).

• **Block C2 Infrastructure at the Network Boundary**: Identify the remote IP addresses, domain names, or user-agent strings associated with the C2 traffic from firewall or proxy logs, and add them to global blocklists (firewall, DNS sinkhole, perimeter web filter).

• **Revoke & Reset Compromised Session Tokens / Credentials**: Immediately reset passwords and revoke active Kerberos tickets (tgt) and OAuth tokens for SOCBYTE\Administrator and any other user account logged into the machine during the compromised window.

• **Audit & Disable Unverified Remote Management Tools**: Identify and close unauthorized remote connectivity services or backdoors that may have been staged to maintain access (e.g., unauthorized SSH daemons, rogue VPN profiles, or third-party remote desktop software like AnyDesk/TeamViewer).

• **Inspect Active Firewall Rules**: Check local host firewall rules (netsh advfirewall) to ensure the attacker did not create inbound opening rules or port forwarding to bypass perimeter defenses.